

Optimizing the timing of pre-approval information exchange (PIE) engagement for oncology products, products for rare diseases, and cell and gene therapies (CGTs)

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Background

- In 2022, the Consolidated Appropriations Act, 2023, was passed and codified a permanent safe harbor for manufacturers to proactively engage in pre-approval information exchange (PIE) with healthcare decision-makers (HCDMs).¹
- In past surveys, HCDMs have indicated that, for certain product categories, including oncology products, products for rare diseases, and cell and gene therapies (CGTs), early PIE is critical for decision-making.²

Objective

- To investigate when HCDMs desire certain types of pre-approval information for oncology products, products for rare diseases, and CGTs and what impact PIE has on patient access.

Methods

- A web-based survey was fielded with advisors from Cencora's Managed Care Network (MCN) from May 6 to May 16, 2024.
 - MCN is a proprietary research panel of over 160 healthcare executives, medical and pharmacy directors, and other experienced individuals in managed care.
 - Participation in this survey was voluntary, and a modest honorarium was paid by Cencora to participants who completed the survey.
 - HCDMs who did not use pre-approval information in the drug evaluation process were excluded from participating in the survey.
- Descriptive statistics were used to summarize multiple-choice responses.

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Results

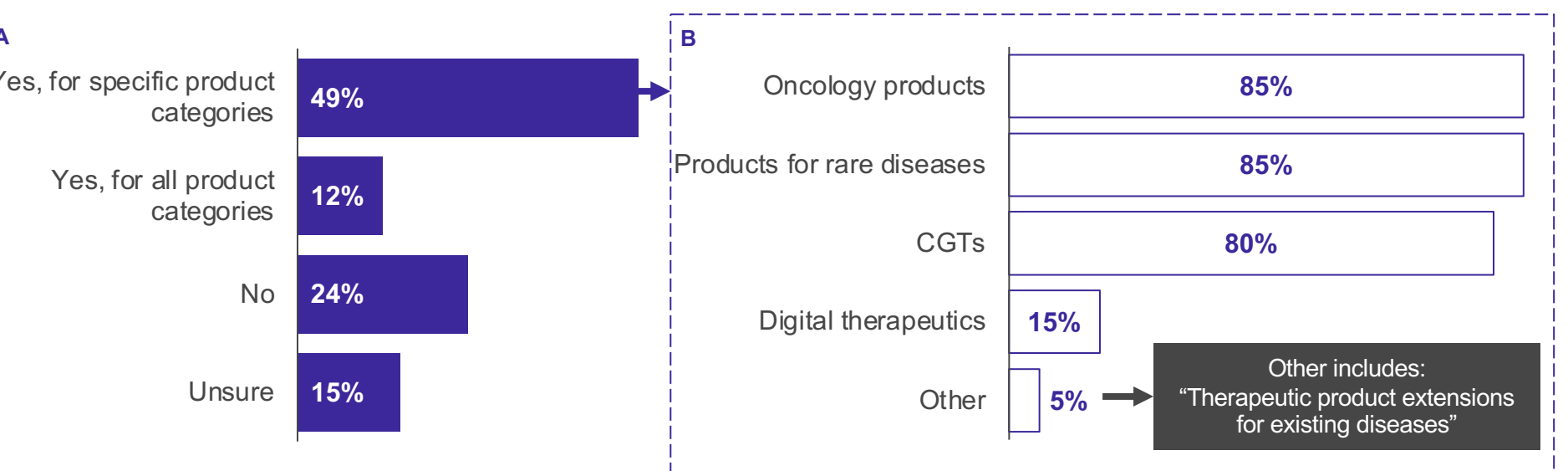
Demographics

- A total of 41 HCDMs responded to the survey, representing health plans (51%), pharmacy benefit managers (32%), and integrated delivery networks (17%), with roles as pharmacy directors (66%), medical directors (24%), and pharmacy managers/trade relations (10%).
- Pharmacy and Therapeutics (P&T) committee roles included voting members (78%), presenters (49%), medical or clinical advisors (46%), and chairs or co-chairs (41%). Responsibilities included making coverage recommendations (93%), voting on coverage decisions at meetings (85%), conducting clinical reviews (80%), negotiating contracts with manufacturers (68%), and preparing or presenting drug reviews (51%).

PIE accelerates access to products

- Of the HCDM respondents, 49% indicated that patients would gain access to a product sooner if PIE were conducted for *specific product categories*. Among these respondents, categories included oncology products (85%), products for rare diseases (85%), and CGTs (80%) (Figure 1).

Figure 1. Impact of PIE on timing of patients access to product categories

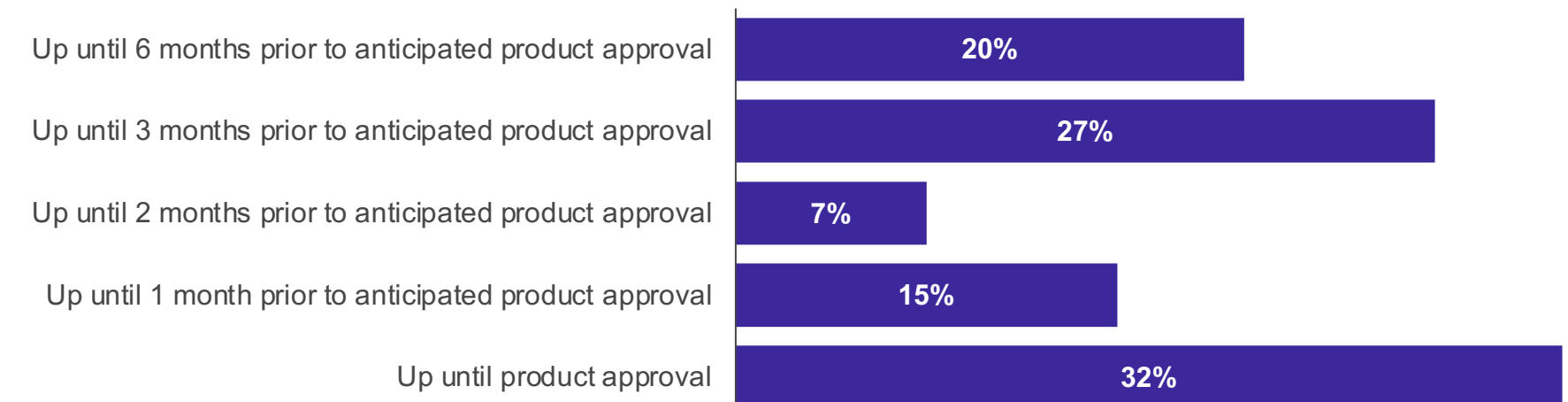


Survey questions: **A.** Would patients gain access to a product sooner if PIE were conducted? (N=41). **B.** For which specific product categories would patients gain access to a product sooner if PIE were conducted? (n=20).
Key: PIE – pre-approval information exchange.

Timing to engage in PIE

- For all products, nearly half (47%) of HCDMs reported that the latest timeframe by which manufacturers should engage in PIE was up to 6 or 3 months before anticipated Food and Drug Administration (FDA) product approval (Figure 2).

Figure 2. Timing preference for receiving pre-approval information among HCDMs

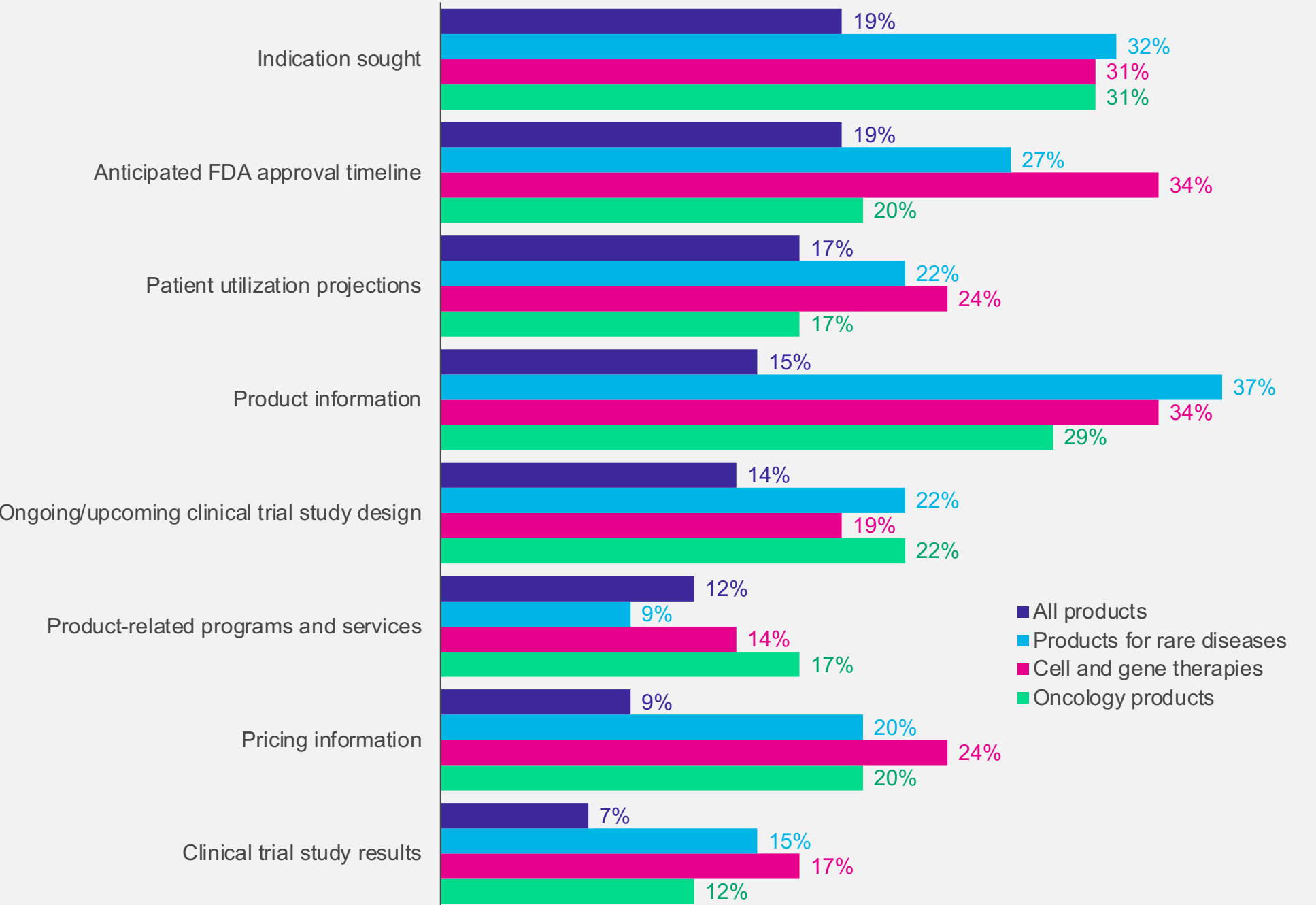


Survey question: When is the latest manufacturers should be engaging in PIE with your organization? (N=41).
Note: "Up until 12 months prior to anticipated product approval" was an option but was not selected by any respondents.
Key: HCDM – healthcare decision-maker; PIE – pre-approval information exchange.

PIE considerations for specific product categories

- Relative to all products, HCDMs desired most types of pre-approval information earlier for products for rare diseases, CGTs, and oncology products (Figure 3).
- Types of pre-approval information most often desired >12 months before anticipated FDA approval included product information (all products: 15%; products for rare diseases: 37%; CGTs: 34%; oncology products: 29%), anticipated FDA approval timeline (19%; 27%; 34%; 20%), and indication sought (19%; 32%; 31%; 31%) (Figure 3).

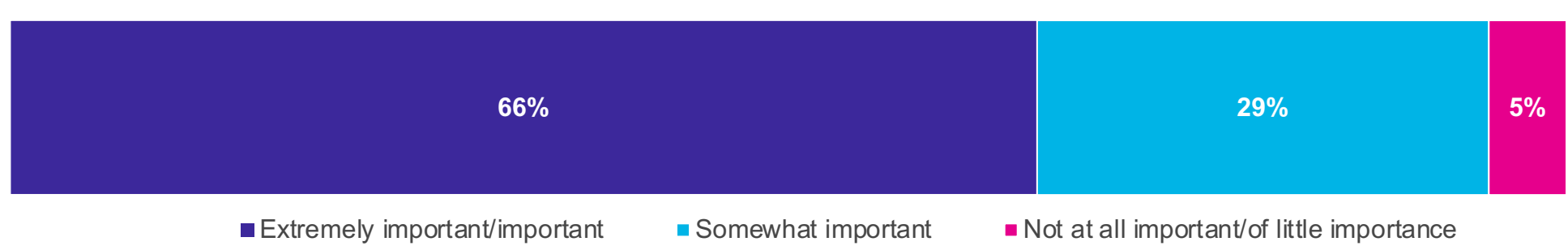
Figure 3. Types of pre-approval information desired >12 months prior to approval



Survey question: Please indicate your organization's preferred timing for each type of pre-approval information prior to approval/authorization for each product type (N=41).
Key: FDA – Food and Drug Administration.

- HCDMs noted that PIE was extremely important or important (66%) for products under expedited approval pathways by the FDA (Figure 4).

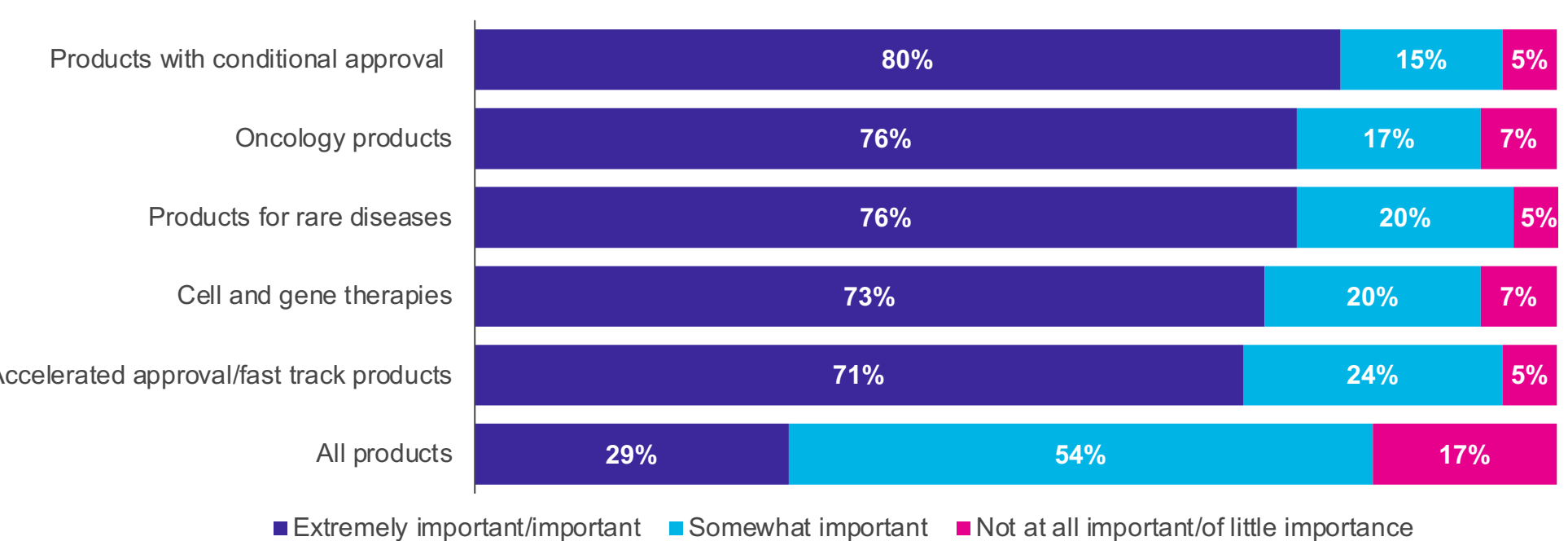
Figure 4. Importance of PIE for products under expedited approval pathways



Survey question: How important is it for a manufacturer to communicate pre-approval information for a product under an expedited approval pathway by the FDA? (N=41).
Key: FDA – Food and Drug Administration; PIE – pre-approval information exchange.

- HCDMs noted that phase 2 data prior to approval were extremely important or important for oncology products (76%), products for rare diseases (76%), and CGTs (73%) compared to 29% for all products (Figure 5).

Figure 5. Importance of phase 2 data during pre-approval among product types



Survey question: Prior to approval, for what product types are phase 2 data important? (N=41).

Limitations

- This study encapsulates the perspectives of a small sample of recruited HCDMs from Cencora's MCN research panel.
- The respondent sample had greater representation from pharmacy directors at national health plans, which could affect generalizability of the results across all types of HCDMs.

Conclusions

- Relative to all products, HCDMs desired pre-approval information sooner for oncology products, products for rare diseases, and CGTs. Pre-approval communication of phase 2 data was more highly valued for these products.
- Some HCDMs indicated that patients could gain access to these products sooner if pre-approval information were communicated.
- To facilitate patient access to products in these categories, manufacturers should consider earlier PIE engagement with HCDMs.

Sponsorship: Cencora.

References: 1. 117th Congress. Consolidated Appropriations Act, 2023, HR 2617 (§3630). Facilitating exchange of product information prior to approval. Accessed September 19, 2024. <https://www.congress.gov/bills/117th-congress/house-bill/2617/text> 2. Malliqi A, Penley B, Young N, Dragovich CM. Early implementation of PIE for specific drug categories. Poster presented at: AMCP 2024; April 15-18, 2024; New Orleans, LA.